

The First World War

SQP 2023

5. Mention any two clauses of the Treaty of Versailles. **MAIN 2023**

6. Name the two alliances formed in Europe before the beginning of the First World War.

MAIN 2023

7. Which region was the cause of tension between France and Germany ?

MAIN 2023

8. (i) Identify the event in the picture and state how it became the immediate cause of the First World War.



(ii) State any three other causes of the First World War.

(iii) Mention any three clauses of the Treaty of Versailles.

MAIN 2023

9. Why did the League of Nations collapse and who replaced it ?

COMP 2023

10. What was the effect of the First World War on the colonial possessions of industrialised countries ?

SQP 2022

11. How did imperialistic rivalry create hatred among nations?

SQP 2022

12. Name the signatory countries of the Triple Alliance (1882). State the rival bloc that was formed.

MAIN 2022

13. What was the war indemnity imposed on Germany through the Treaty of Versailles ?

or

**What was the amount of reparation that Germany had to pay the allies ?
Mention any two terms of the treaty of Versailles which affected the German military ?**

MAIN 2022

14. The First World War had a devastating effect on the world and caused unprecedented destruction. With reference to the First World War, answer the following questions.

(i) Name the signatory countries of the Triple Entente.

(ii) What is meant by the term Imperialism ?

(iii) Explain the immediate cause of the First World War.

(iv) What was the amount of war reparation that Germany had to pay the allies ? Mention any two terms of the Treaty of Versailles which affected the German military.

MAIN 2022

15. Name the two major countries which were not allowed to become the member of the League of Nations.

COMP 2022

16. What is nationalism ?

COMP 2022

17. What refers to the sense of unity felt by people who share a common history and culture that came to fore in beginning of the 20th century?

(a) Communism

(b) Fascism

(c) Nationalism

(d) Imperialism

COMP 2021

Solution

1.

Ans:

(i) Loss of Life and Money:

Millions of people were killed or wounded during World War I, and large-scale destruction caused severe economic loss. Nations spent enormous amounts on the war, and industries, farms, and towns were damaged, weakening the global economy.

(ii) Changes in the Political Map of the World:

The Treaty of Versailles and other agreements after the war redrew the world map. New nations like Poland, Czechoslovakia, and Yugoslavia were created, while empires such as Austria-Hungary, Germany, and the Ottoman Empire lost significant territories.

(iii) Emergence of the Democratic Spirit After World War I:

After the war, several monarchies collapsed, leading to the rise of democratic governments. Germany became a republic, Russia established a People's Government after the 1917 Revolution, and Italy also transitioned into a republic.

2.

Ans: (c) Sarajevo Crisis.

Explanation:

The immediate cause of the First World War was the Sarajevo Crisis of 1914, triggered by the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria. This event set off a chain reaction of alliances and conflicts, ultimately leading to the outbreak of the war.

3.

Ans: (c) Encouraging nationalism in Asia.

Explanation:

At the end of the 19th century, British and French policies focused on **increasing trade, exploiting colonial resources, and protecting their**

colonies. They did **not** encourage nationalism in Asia, as nationalist movements threatened their colonial rule.

Therefore, option **(c)** is correct.

4.

Ans: (a) Paris conference

The Treaty of Versailles was signed as a result of the discussions at the Paris Peace Conference, which took place in 1919 and 1920. The primary purpose of the conference was to establish the terms of peace after World War I. The major powers involved were the United States, Great Britain, and France.

5.

Ans:

(i) Reparations – Germany was required to pay heavy war compensation to the Allied countries for the losses caused during World War I.

(ii) Territorial losses – Germany lost important territories, including **Alsace-Lorraine to France** and parts of **Prussia to Poland**.

6.

Ans:

(i) The Triple Alliance (1882) – Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy.

(ii) The Triple Entente (1907) – France, Russia and Britain.

7.

Ans: The region was **Alsace-Lorraine**, which France had lost to Germany after the **Franco–Prussian War of 1870**.

8.

Ans:

(i) The event shown in the picture is the **assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria and his wife Sophie at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914**.

This incident became the immediate cause of the First World War as Austria-Hungary held Serbia responsible, declared war on it, and the system of alliances drew the major European powers into the conflict.

(ii) Three other causes of the First World War were:

- **Militant Nationalism**
- **Arms Race**
- **Alliance System**

(iii) Three clauses of the Treaty of Versailles were:

- **Rhineland Demilitarisation** – The Rhineland was demilitarised and occupied by Allied troops for 15 years.
- **Colonial Losses of Germany** – Germany lost all her colonies to the Allied powers.
- **Military Restrictions** – Germany's army was limited to 100,000 soldiers and her navy was reduced, with bans on air force and submarines.

9.

Ans: The League of Nations collapsed because it failed to prevent international conflicts and had no power to enforce its decisions. Major powers like the USA did not join, and aggressive actions by countries such as Germany and Italy weakened it.

It was replaced by the **United Nations** in **1945**.

10.

Ans: Germany lost all its colonies after the First World War. These colonies were taken over by Britain, France and Belgium and were administered as **mandates under the League of Nations**.

11.

Ans: Imperialistic rivalry created hatred among nations as powerful countries competed to acquire colonies for trade and wealth. Britain already had a vast empire in Asia and Africa, while other nations like Germany, Italy, the Netherlands, and the USA also sought colonies. This competition led to rivalry, tension, and conflicts among nations, contributing to the outbreak of the First World War.

12.

Ans: The signatory countries of the **Triple Alliance (1882)** were **Germany**,

Austria-Hungary, and Italy.

The rival bloc formed was the **Triple Entente**, consisting of **France, Russia, and Britain**.

13.

Ans: The war indemnity imposed on Germany under the Treaty of Versailles was **33 billion US dollars (132 billion gold marks)**.

Two terms of the Treaty of Versailles that affected the German military were:

(i) Reduction of the Army – Germany's army was limited to **100,000 troops** and conscription was banned.

(ii) Restrictions on Military Equipment – Germany was forbidden to have **tanks, submarines, and an air force**, and its navy was greatly reduced.

14.

Ans:

(i) Signatory countries of the Triple Alliance:

Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy.

(ii) Imperialism:

Imperialism is the policy by which a powerful nation extends its control over other countries by political, economic or military means to exploit their resources.

(iii) Immediate cause of the First World War:

The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria and his wife at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914.

(iv) War indemnity and terms affecting Germany:

Germany was required to pay 132 billion gold marks as war indemnity.

Two terms affecting the German military were:

(a) The German army was limited to 100,000 soldiers and conscription was banned.

(b) Germany was prohibited from having an air force and submarines, and its navy was greatly reduced.

15.

Ans:

(i) Germany

(ii) The Soviet Union

16.

Ans: Nationalism is a feeling of unity and loyalty among people who share a common culture, history, traditions and identity. It creates a sense of belonging to one nation and encourages people to work together for national unity and independence.

17.

Ans: (c) Nationalism

Explanation:

Nationalism refers to the feeling of unity and oneness among people who share a common history, culture and traditions. This sense of unity became especially strong at the beginning of the 20th century.